

Classic Tales

Tenali Rama and the Thieves

KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Long ago, in the kingdom of Vijayanagara, there lived a minister named Tenali Rama. His cleverness was famous far and wide.

One night, Tenali Rama heard a rustle in the courtyard. He peeped out of the window — two thieves had climbed over the wall!



Tenali Rama gently woke his wife and whispered something in her ear. Then he spoke out loud, so the thieves could hear.

"Listen, dear wife!" he called. "The king has given me many diamonds and jewels. I am afraid of thieves, so I will drop this treasure box into our well. We will take it out in the morning!"



With that, he lifted a big box and dropped it into the well —
SPLASH!

The thieves grinned at each other. "All the treasure is in the
well! Tonight it will be ours."



Tenali Rama went inside and fell asleep — snore, snore, snore. At midnight, the two thieves crept to the well. "First we must take out all the water," they said, "then the box is ours!"



Bucket by bucket, they pulled up water — slosh, slosh, slosh!



Then Tenali Rama came out, laughing. "Well done!" he cried. "You are watering my garden trees! Come, let me help you!"



He took the buckets and poured the water onto his trees. All night long, the poor thieves drew water from the well — and all night long, Tenali Rama watered his trees with it!



By morning, the two thieves were tired to the bone. Just then, the soldiers arrived and caught them both.



And the treasure box? It was full of nothing but stones!



The king praised Tenali Rama greatly, and Tenali Rama's garden bloomed like never before.

There is no power greater than a
clever mind.

The End

